



❧ THE ROLEPLAYING GAME ❧

QUICK-START RULES



# FROSTPUNK

## QUICK START RULES

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fco.p.blas@hotmail.com



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## FROSTPUNK

# A WORLD OF ICE AND STEAM



There are three constants:

Cold.

Work.

And the Moan.

The first is an ever-present danger. The second is our best weapon to fight it. And the third is proof that our weapon is working.

We have had bad nights in our city, many bad nights, but the worst was the night the Moan stopped. There were other close calls—times when we weren't sure we'd have enough coal to last until morning, or when we noticed critical wear on a regulator, and frantically had to repair it before it snapped and shut everything down. Those events caused plenty of stress and concern, but each time we figured out a way past the problem before it erupted into a full-bore disaster.

But then, one night, as we huddled under blankets and tried to relax overworked muscles after a twelve-hour shift, the Moan that is the constant noise at the center of our settlement stopped. The city became quieter than the first days after our arrival, and heat rapidly fled from our buildings. We looked out doors and windows, hoping to see something other than what we, deep down, knew to be the truth.

Our hopes were dashed. The generator had shut down.

The generator is the center of our city and our existence. If they break down on an especially bad day, people in the city will start dying in a matter of hours. *Hours.* You may have ingenious plans, a hardworking attitude, and plentiful resources, but if your generator is not working, none of it will mean a thing.

When we first arrived at our city sites, there were two things there: piles of resources and a steam generator. Those who came before us knew our efforts would be pointless without the generator, so they made sure we had one. Even in the pit that holds New London, the generator emerges above the rim as a landmark, showing anyone nearby where the city is. Steam pours out of it in large pillars, kept compact by the frozen air.

We build around the generator, quite literally. Our streets are either circles that surround the generator or spokes leading out from it. All roads lead to it, and all of our strength flows from it.

This is the first thing we will tell our children, when those born in our new home are old enough to understand. You depend on the city—and the city depends on the generator.

Then we will tell them how it got to be that way.

## VOICES OF THE NORTH

### INTERRUPTED MOAN

I remember the Moan.

It stopped, and there was another noise—a low wail. The temperature dropped immediately. The generator pushes the cold back constantly, but once that push stops, the cold invades. Even in the earlier times, when the frost first hit, I didn't see a moment like that, because back then we didn't know. Back then we were scrambling all the time, thinking we could fix it, we could stop it.

Once we had gone north, though, we knew. The cold had beaten us, and it would never be defeated, only held at bay. So, when the generator went off, we all knew it had won again. It would claim some of us in its unrelenting advance.

By morning, the generator was working again. And nearly sixty people were dead.

## REMARKS BY THE RIGHT REVEREND NAOMI SUSSKIND ON THE FIRST ANNIVERSARY OF THE GREAT FROST

Somewhere, well outside our city, sits a mound of snow and ice that covers the remains of one of our own. A citizen—more than one, in truth—wandered away from our city at night, sat in the snow, and waited for the inevitable to overtake them. It cannot have taken long. Then snow and ice covered their tracks and their remains before we could find them, so they remain out there, a permanent part of the stark landscape that surrounds us.

Can any of us say we do not understand their motivation? They lived the life we all live. A life of little sun and even less warmth. A life of long work days followed by not enough rest, and days like that stacking on each other and extending indefinitely into the future,



## OUR RECENT PAST

**1847:** Charles Babbage leads the construction of the first analytical engine. A global engineering arms race follows.

**1862:** To respond to the engineering competition that has created needs for new resources, the Imperial Exploration Company (IEC), backed by the British crown, launches its first survey of "lands north."

**1863-69:** As IEC expeditions continue, other nations launch missions of their own to compete for resources.

**1874:** The American Association for the Advancement of Science hosts a presentation of a paper by Eunice Newton Foote showing that a recent trend of cooling temperatures across the globe appeared to be accelerating. Most governments dismiss her conclusions, but scientists seek to confirm and further investigate the cooling trend.

**1881:** Evidence of global cooling has become overwhelming, and already temperature declines are upsetting agriculture, commerce, food supplies, and more. Governments realize they need to prepare for the worst. Plans for the first generators, which will be the lynchpin of future settlements, begin.

**1882:** International tensions in Europe erupt into the Great Balkan War, which is focused on gaining control of coal resources in the region as well as exploiting critical shipping lanes.

**1883:** The first automaton is put to work in a forest in Wales, doing the work of dozens of lumberjacks. A scientific settlement known as Winterhome is built in the lands north. As the Balkan War escalates, the United Kingdom institutes military conscription, which is met by popular resistance.

**1885:** A functional generator prototype is finally completed. The IEC decides to immediately start deploying them in the lands north, with the first one being built in Winterhome. Continual escalation of hostility to English military conscription ends when mechanized lancers shatter protests. Official body counts are never released, but estimates go above one thousand.

**Fall 1885:** The Last Autumn. An unprecedented cold wave devastates crops in India and the Southern Hemisphere. Many British colonials decide to return to a country already pressed for resources and are met with anger and resentment.

**1886:** The Great Frost. While this was initially perceived as a unique event, it actually was the first of multiple waves of continually declining temperatures. Spring and summer never arrive in this year, replaced instead by deeper and deeper freezes. Famine and cold take millions of lives, and the British Empire collapses. Planned expeditions increase in pace, and refugees also start flooding northward, hoping the settlements there will provide more stability than the collapsing civilizations around them.

the same way the white land stretches into an indistinct grey horizon. And so some see no purpose in that labor, and they lose hope, and they walk out and become one with the grey.

You, however, have not. All of you hearing my voice right now have chosen not to give up. Chosen not to give in. I have asked myself a simple question: Why?

Some of it is the stubbornness of humanity. I have walked through our infirmaries and seen people suffering from crushed limbs, struggling lungs, and all other manner of ill health. I have seen them breathe what I was sure would be their last breath, then breathe again. I have seen people many believed would never walk again lead a work crew back into a mine. For all their weakness, our bodies sometimes simply do not seem to know how to give up.

We are driven by more than mere instinct, though. Every day we survive attests to the fact that we *can* survive. And in the course of that day, someone smiles, someone laughs, and someone fights off the cold through the warmth of company of others. They may be brief moments, but that does not make them any less real. Even if those moments were not ours as individuals, they were ours as a community.

That, in the end, is truly what keeps us going. Our

city. Each other. We are not just living for what we can gain for ourselves, but for the life we can give to each other. We can remember the life we lived before, and we know this life is different. We depend on each other like we never have before. In all we do, in every decision we make, four words stay in our minds, pointing us to what we need to do to make life and any chance at a future possible:

*The city must survive.*

## THE WORLD BEFORE AND THE WORLD NOW

### THOUGHTS OF DEPUTY MARSHAL CARVILLE BANKS

Our settlements have many gathering places—fighting pits, public houses, churches, cookhouses, and more. There is an unspoken agreement in all of them that we don't talk about the old days. Our pubs, with their shaky wooden walls and plain benches, are no match for the taverns back home, with their abundant flower boxes and polished wood. Our soups, which are flavored with salt if we're fortunate, are no match for the delicately seasoned dishes we sipped in cheery



restaurants. And our churches are impressive for the fact that they haven't collapsed on themselves, rather than for any stunning feat of architecture.

Just because we don't talk about it does not mean we don't remember, though. We do, and it stings. Sometimes, rather than relying on smoldering coal, we burn wood, and the scent of woodsmoke traveling through cold air reminds us of cozy fireplaces on a winter's night. Or when the light of a church is dim, and people bow in prayer over a small candle, the glow of their faces looks the same as it did back then.

We see those things, then we turn away.

We are not well served by memory.

Still, the changes are not all negative. The world as it was before was far from perfect. If I press myself, I can develop a list of ways the world has changed for—well, if not the better, then not the worse, either.

### PRIORITIES ARE CLEARER

It was easy, in the times before, to sometimes get lost in many competing demands for our time. We worried about obtaining tasteful trappings for our homes, attending the proper social gatherings, and making good impressions on the right people.

Most of that is now cast aside. We have one priority, day in and day out, and that is survival. What machines need to function to keep us warm? How much food do we need? Are the sick receiving proper care? These are clear, elemental needs, and they take up almost our entire lives.

We don't have to worry about whether or not we are making progress on these items. While in the past we may have wondered about our social standing and how we were viewed, in our present, we know when we have succeeded in fixing a machine, feeding a family, or healing a patient.

The needs we face are relentless and demanding, to the point that they are our only considerations.

### WASTE IS REDUCED

You could not walk through one of our old cities without seeing how much we wasted. Produce rotted in merchants' stalls, industrial facilities dumped materials into rivers and lakes, and buildings full of useful bricks and beams were left to rot and crumble.

Now, we waste nothing. Anything that can be used is used. Any part of a plant or animal that is at all edible is consumed. Anything broken is repaired. The nail you salvage today may be critical in sealing a gap and keeping out a deadly wind tomorrow. We know that every last thing we have is precious.

### FRIVOLITY IS LESSENER

I am well aware that many among us do not see this as an improvement. They miss the grand theaters, the magnificent orchestras, the long afternoons and nights of chatting and playing cards or dice.

Our pleasures are simpler today. A warm meal, a good story, and a quick song before shuffling wearily to bed. Our free time, such as it is, is often spent doing tasks that are not our primary job but are still, by all reasonable definitions, work. We build, we scavenge, we tend the young, we organize what we have. Time is a resource, and resources are not to be wasted.

### WE SHARE THE BURDEN OF WORK

We have much work to do, and it takes large parts of every day, but we also occasionally have assistance without which survival would be impossible. Before the Great Frost, civilization developed the mighty automatons, and a select number of them continue to function to this day. While the knowledge to create them is lost, some of the machines are sturdy enough to keep working, and we have even been able to make some basic repairs.

When functional, an automaton performs perhaps ten percent of our city's work. When in human history have we had something non-human that does as much of our work for us? The only correct answer is never. While we still must work long hours to survive, automatons have pitched in to do more work than we could have done for ourselves, making survival possible. As they age and fall to the wayside, we salute their creators, and hope someday to rediscover the knowledge to build them anew.



FROSTPUNK

# QUICK START RULES

*Frostpunk: The Roleplaying Game* uses the *Dice Core* system explained in this booklet. A quick review of the rules and the adventure, and you'll be ready to embrace the challenge of the hope, discontent, and societal survival in the icy cold.

**Important Terms:** The first time an important term is introduced, it is **bolded**.

## A CONVERSATION

Engaging with *Frostpunk: The Roleplaying Game* is a shared conversation, whether around a physical or virtual tabletop. The gamemaster shares details of what's around you, and what other people are doing. For example, they might say: "You leave the food tent. It's still bitterly cold as the sun—that you never see—hasn't risen yet. The fresh snowfall from last night crunches as you sink past the ice-encrusted top layer to the soft powder underneath. The Beacon Master tromps by, face stoic as ever, but glances in your direction. What do you do?"

Then the players will join the conversation, narrating what their character's are doing, or even speaking as though they are the character. For example, they might:

- **Aleksy (as Clara):** "A good day to you sir." I nod my head to the Beacon Master. **GM:** He nods stiffly in your direction. His frown deepens a touch.
- **Qadira (as Martha):** I ignore him, huddle more in my furs, and start walking toward the supply tent, muttering about how we've a long trip ahead of us. **GM:** Okay. You notice the challenges of walking in the new snowpack.
- **Joaquín (as Arnold):** "Martha, where are you going?" **Qadira:** "To the supply tent. Big trip coming up." **Joaquín:** I follow her. **Qadira:** I'll follow, too. **GM:** Great.
- **Emilee (as Justin):** I wait until everyone is moving away from me. Is the Beacon Master still looking at us? **GM:** He's a little ways down the street, but he looks back again. **Emilee:** I give him a hand signal saying I want to talk. **GM:** You know him well enough? **Emilee:** I speak with everybody. All the time. And you said he had a knack for spotting things. Pretty sure an unobtrusive hand signal will get his attention. **GM:** Okay, sounds good. He gives you a nod and abruptly steps toward an alley. **Emilee:** I follow.
- **GM:** What are the rest of you doing right now?

As you think of the next thing to say and the next thing to do, the story will unfold. Just as an especially engaging conversation at a party will last longer and draw more interest, the more the players participate, the more they will create an engaging and unforgettable gaming session.



the character at the gaming table, making the decisions the character would make as they respond to the challenges the game throws their way.

The inside of each pre-generated player character is a first-person fiction vignette, along with some questions the players can ask themselves that will help them ease into how they wish to play the characters. There is also a more in-depth background description, along with a series of keywords that serve as tags the player can use to help them decide how they'll react in a given situation.

- **Background:** Your profession before the Great Frost.
- **Disposition:** Your inherent world viewpoint: positive or negative, optimistic or pessimistic, hopeful or discontented.
- **Integrity:** Your inner moral values, the lines you will not cross. What people cannot see on the surface but can only perceive through your words and deeds as they observe your life.
- **Personality:** The attitude and body language you portray; what everyone sees and feels the moment they encounter you.
- **Bonds:** Even in a post-apocalyptic world—perhaps especially in such a world—who you care about, along with the people and places you know, are crucial. These Bonds provide compelling reasons for why you want to protect your city or your people—or why you don't.

## DICE 1

*Dice Core* uses the following polyhedral dice, with a series of corresponding icons throughout the rules and on the character sheets: D4 , D6 , D8 , D10 , and D12 . **Building a Dice Pool** and taking actions will be covered shortly. But from the very start, keep this in mind: the Upgrades/Downgrades graphic on the character sheet  shows that your odds of succeeding at a given action increase as the dice grows; i.e., a  is better than a , a  is better than a , and so on.

## DICE ICONS

As indicated, the character sheet uses color-coded dice icons to help players easily select dice during the game. Each icon is color-coded, shape-coded, and word-coded. This allows any player to decide which code they'll use for their dice and play style. For example, some will use polyhedrals they already have and will use either the word-code (D4) or shape-code (triangle) to clue them which dice to grab. Others will find it useful to acquire polyhedrals that match the

color-coding on the record sheet, allowing them to use colors to prompt them which dice to grab, e.g., a green die. Whichever way works best for you, run with it!

## ATTRIBUTES 3

**Attributes** represent the core elements of your character. Everything else, from **skills** to the actions you take, including combat, rest upon the bedrock of these natural elements. Attributes are represented on the character sheet by color-coded polyhedral icons, as described above.

*Dice Core* uses the following Attributes:

## ENDURANCE

Endurance represents your character's physical strength and stamina.

## AGILITY

How easily can you dodge through a street of rushing people or snag the falling piece of evidence of a terrible crime before it disappears down a crevasse? Agility is your character's ability to physically react quickly and with finesse in a given situation.

## CONVICTION

When the pain is too much, will you still stand back up? When there's an innocent person in your way and a hundred other lives are on the line, will you pull the knife with a steady hand? Your character's Conviction measures their mental strength and drive.

## INGENUITY

Who's currently the best hunter feeding New London? How damaged can the automaton you stole be and still function? If I punch a guard, will I be arrested? Your character's knowledge, decision-making process, and general wisdom about how to react in various situations is represented by their Ingenuity.

## INFLUENCE

When you walk into a room, do others orient toward you? Can you quirk a smile and raise an eyebrow, and suddenly there are extra food rations on the table for you? Or can you talk the toughest thug into divulging their feelings? Your charismatic ability to influence events is covered here.



## RESOLVE

Does karma love you? Do you always seem to have an edge just when you need it? Do you have the flair to unleash a burst of energy, luck, or both? Resolve represents that ephemeral knack for the coin always landing on your chosen side, the sudden energetic charge, or the lucky break opening right as you need it.

## SKILLS

While attributes represent the inherent elements of your character, skills are learned areas of knowledge. These cover a wide range of abilities, from combat and engineering, to scholarship and general book learning and knowledge. While any character can attempt any action in the game, skills increase the odds you'll succeed.

*Dice Core* uses the following skills; each contains a cursory description. Also note that not all skills are found on all character sheets. Instead, the full list is provided for the gamemaster to use as guidelines during each game.

**Linked Attributes:** Skills are organized by their Linked Attribute. This means that in a **Feat**, when you use that skill, you must use the corresponding Attribute, as noted in the Sample Feats section (see p. 12) and as indicated on the character sheet with each skill (in parenthesis next to each name).

## ENDURANCE

- **Athletics:** You can keep climbing, keep working, keep running, or even just keep walking.
- **Intensity:** When others give up because of mental or physical exhaustion, you keep going.
- **Survival:** Trapped, alone and in the cold, you know what must be done to survive.

## AGILITY

- **Close Combat:** Whether hand-to-hand, a knife or a staff, you put your opponent down.
- **Gymnastics:** Leaping, jumping, dodging: action is a fine dance you master with ease.
- **Ranged Combat:** Whether you're using a bow, javelin, or gun, you know how to aim and hit a moving target.
- **Sleight of Hand:** The coin dances, the coin disappears; distraction is always the game.

## CONVICTION

- **Engagement:** You're always on alert, finding a concealed weapon or discovering an escape route.
- **Leadership:** It's not about stepping in front, but knowing those behind will follow.

- **Scavenging:** Just a little bit of scrap and you'll have a makeshift weapon or a firing engine.
- **Stealth:** Slipping through the snow, or standing unseen in a crowd, you know the benefits of not being noticed.

## INGENUITY

- **Awareness:** Whether in a deep conversation or hanging on a cliff, you notice the unusual.
- **Engineering:** You dream of cogs and understand how to visualize and plan any construction.
- **Forgery:** A letter, a footprint in the snow, or a splash of blood—you can fake nearly anything.
- **Investigation:** Who stole the food? What's that sound in the night? What's this pile of junk for? You look into all of those things.
- **Medicine:** From first aid to dietary and physical upkeep, you know how to keep others well.
- **Mechanic:** Engineers plan and build, but only you keep it running—or bring it back to life.
- **Scholarship:** A special job classifications skill that ties into your character's Background.\*
  - Agriculture, Husbandry, and Fishing
  - Armed Forces
  - Building
  - Factory
  - Mines and Quarries
  - Professional, Clerical, and Local Gov't
  - Retail, Foodstuffs, and Hostelrys
  - Transport and Communications
  - Workshops and Handicraft
  - Theology

## INFLUENCE

- **Acting:** Bluffing past a guard or hiding as a convalescent in the corner, you can fake your way through many situations.
- **Animal Handling:** A pet dog, a horse, or even a wolf out in the dark—you have a way with animals.
- **Persuasion:** Whether you need an extra meal, another pair of gloves, or a covered workshift, there's always a mark to provide it.

*\* As noted above, Scholarship is divided into nine sub-Scholarship Skills, each of which is connected to a character's Background. In other words, if your character has Scholarship, it is automatically centered on your character's Background.*

*If you are attempting a Research Feat (see p. 9) for information that is found within another Background that is not part of your skill apply a ↓. The GM may apply ↓↓ if the Classifications are very removed from each other, such as Armed Forces and Factory.*



## SKILL STAGES

As noted previously, the higher a die, the better your actions. To reflect this there are nine **skill stages** of progression, as shown (lowest to highest outcome of possible success). Most of the characters do not have the highest levels; they are provided as a reference.

| SKILL STAGES |  |
|--------------|--|
| 4 (no skill) |  |
| 6            |  |
| 4 + ↑        |  |
| 8            |  |
| 6 + ↑        |  |
| 10           |  |
| 8 + ↑        |  |
| 12           |  |
| 10 + ↑       |  |
| 12 + ↑       |  |

↑ **Upgrade** means automatically Upgrading one of the dice in the Feat Pool by one better value; see below for more details.

## FEATS

### (THE ACTIONS OF THE GAME)

When playing *Frostpunk*, many actions your character takes don't really have a possibility of failure, or the possibility is so small it's basically irrelevant. In those instances, the characters simply take those actions. However, any time you take an action that has a significant chance of failure or the failure will have a meaningful impact, the dice should come out.

Feats are any action that requires rolling dice to resolve whether you are successful or not in that action. *Dice Core* is designed to be quick and smooth to play, making the dice rolling fast and easy to resolve so the story and your players' imaginations can take center stage. As such, the Feats in *Dice Core* are kept to relatively wide categories. It is up to you, your gaming group, and the gamemaster to take the broad strokes provided in these rules and flesh them out for any given situation.

## FEAT ROLLS & THE FEAT POOL (THE BASICS)

For every action that requires a dice roll to determine its success or failure—a Feat Roll—you build a Feat Pool.

That pool always involves three polyhedral dice.

### BUILDING THE FEAT POOL

You always begin building a Feat Pool by selecting the Feat Die, which is always a 8. Then, based upon the Feat in question, you add one skill die. (If there is no applicable skill die, the player adds a default 4.) Finally the player adds one Linked Attribute die.

So the Dice Pool equation is as follows:

| Feat Die | + Skill Die | + Linked Attribute Die | + Upgrade/Downgrade |
|----------|-------------|------------------------|---------------------|
| 8        | + 1 Die     | + 1 Die                | + ↑ or ↓            |

### UPGRADES/DOWNGRADES

Once the Feat Pool of three dice is built, based upon the details from your character sheet or from the GM, there is the possibility of **Upgrading** ↑ the dice (i.e., exchanging a lower-value die for a higher-value die) or **Downgrading** ↓ the dice (i.e., exchanging a higher-value die for a lower-value die).

### MAKING A FEAT ROLL

Once the Feat Pool is finalized and any ↑ or ↓ made, the player rolls the dice and totals the rolled numbers. This number is compared to a **Difficulty Rating (DR)** generated by the GM—based upon a specific table (see p. 11). If it equals or exceeds the number rolled, success!

## A MORE IN-DEPTH LOOK AT FEATS

Below is a detailed look at building the Feat Pool. You always use the following steps to determine which dice will be rolled for a Feat.

### BUILDING THREE DICE POOL

1. **First Die (8 Feat):** You tell the GM what action you want to take (i.e., Feat), which is often built off the Sample Feats (see p. 12). You then start to build the Feat Pool by *always* grabbing a 8.



2. **Second Die (Skill):** The Feat indicates which skill applies. You then look at the applicable skill on your character sheet and select the indicated die. (If there is no applicable skill, the player adds the default )
3. **Third Die (Linked Attribute):** The Feat also indicates which Linked Attribute applies. You then look at the applicable Attribute on your character sheet and select the indicated die.

## UPGRADES/DOWNGRADES

4. **Make Any Modifications** ( or ): Once the three dice are selected, the player may then have to apply  and . These can be situational (i.e., they came from the GM), or from Weapons or Equipment. Once all  or  are noted, apply them to your dice pool. You can either cancel one  with one , or you can apply them all, as you see fit. So if you have three  and two  applied to the Feat Pool, you may simply apply one  (by canceling two  with two , or you can apply them all, as you choose (see the *Upgrades/Downgrades*, at right, for more details).

## MAKE THE FEAT ROLL

5. **Roll Feat Pool:** With your dice assembled, you now make a Feat Roll by rolling all three final dice, adding the numbers on each die into a total and informing the GM of that total.
  - **Success:** If the final amount is equal to or greater than the Difficulty Rating (DR) assigned by the GM, the action was a success, and you can bask in the heady euphoria of victory!
  - **Defeat:** If the final amount is less than the Difficulty Rating, the action failed, with the corresponding consequences (see *Difficulty Ratings*, p. 11, for more details).
    - **Critical Successes:** When making a Feat Roll, every 3 over the Difficulty Rating is 1 **Critical Success** (this value can be modified by other rules). A variety of effects in the game are applied based on the Critical Successes of a Feat Roll.
    - **Critical Failures:** These are identical to Critical Successes, but instead of counting above the Difficulty Rating, count below the Difficult Rating for how badly they missed. A variety of effects in the game are applied based on the **Critical Failures** of a Feat Roll.

## AT THE TABLE

Rather quickly, the GM will get a handle on the Dice Pool and how to use it in conjunction with their players. They should learn how to easily tell the players what's needed. For example, a character may say "I'm running down the street, trying to see if I can find the person who ran out the back of the tent." In the first game for everyone, the GM is likely to be formal so everyone can easily understand what's occurring: "Sounds good. That is a Search For a Person Feat, so that's a  + Engagement + Conviction. However, since you're both running, let's put a Downgrade on that." But then, perhaps even in that same first session, the player may say "The blizzard is coming? Can I repair the sled?" and the GM simply responds, "Sure, give me a Mechanic + Ingenuity + a Downgrade roll," since it can be assumed by then that a  is always included.

## UPGRADES/ DOWNGRADES



Dice  and  come in three forms:

- **Situational (GM):** When spears are being thrown in your direction, did you find some good cover? Or are your teammates helping you pull on a rope to keep the sled from falling into the ice? Every situation can apply both  and , some coming from your actions, others coming from the GM.
- **Equipment & Weapons:** Various equipment and weapons may bring an  or  (see character sheets).
- **Opposed Feat Roll:** When making an **Opposed Feat Roll** directly against non-player characters (NPCs), you may cause a  against that NPC, or that NPC may cause a  against you. For example, you may be in a superior position to the NPC, giving the NPC a .



## YOU CHOOSE THE DICE

You always choose which dice you wish to ↑ or ↓, but you can never go above 12 or below 4. A player *must* always ↑ or ↓ if the rules say they need to.

**Maximum Dice:** If you must ↑ but have 12 12 12, simply add 2 to the final result of the die roll. (You never ↓ 4 4 4.)

## DIFFICULTY RATING

The Difficulty Rating is a number generated by the GM representing how hard (or simple) it may be to accomplish a Feat. When a player makes a Feat Roll, the sum of their three dice must equal or exceed the Difficulty Rating for a success.

The Difficulty Ratings are shown on the table below:

| DIFFICULTY RATING | TARGET            |
|-------------------|-------------------|
| Very Easy         | 7 or more         |
| Easy              | 10 or more        |
| <b>STANDARD</b>   | <b>13 OR MORE</b> |
| Hard              | 16 or more        |
| Very Hard         | 19 or more        |
| Master            | 22 or more        |
| Legendary         | 25 or more        |

The gamemaster always starts at Standard difficulty and then shifts the difficulty up or down based on a variety of factors. Difficulties generally shift up in steps of three, but the gamemaster can choose to use the numbers in between if they desire a little more granularity in their Difficulty Rating.

## OPPOSED ROLLS

Feat Rolls against NPCs are called Opposed (Feat) Rolls and follow the same basic format above for building the Feat Pools on both sides; in this instance, the GM will often tell you what dice to select for your Feat Pool if an NPC is targeting you. The result of the target's Feat Roll generates the Difficulty Rating against which the active participant rolls.

## CHANGING DIFFICULTY RATINGS

Shifting the Difficulty Rating is a quick and easy way to adjust the challenge without adding more ↑ or ↓ to player calculations; if the GM sees elements that help or hinder the player, they can adjust the DR down or up 1 (respectively) for each such element.

As a note, for every one-point change in the Difficulty Rating, the chance to succeed decreases around 5 to 9 percent, depending on the Feat Pool and the starting Difficulty Rating. For reference, a single ↓ tends to decrease the chance of success by a slightly higher margin, depending on how elevated the dice pool is.

## FATIGUE

The failure of a Feat may cause **Fatigue**, depending upon the severity of that failure. For example, a Breaking Down the Door failure likely wouldn't cause an actual Wound that would need to be tracked in the game, but it could leave you with a bruised shoulder, represented by Fatigue. If you have enough Fatigue, Wounds can occur.

Anytime a player attempts a Feat and the die roll result has 3 or more Critical Failures (i.e., is 9 or more below the Difficulty Rating), a box is checked off of the **Fatigue Track**.

What Feats can end in the loss of Fatigue is based upon the Feat in question. A Sway or Pick Lock is not likely to end in Fatigue, whereas a Jumping or Close Attack certainly would. The final decision on which Feats may apply Fatigue in failure is up to the GM.

## FATIGUE APPLIES DOWNGRADES

For every Fatigue point, apply a ↓ to all Feats. This is cumulative, based upon the number of Fatigue points. However, a character should never have more than ↓ ↓ ↓ applied to them from any source after all ↑ have been applied (see *Using Upgrades/Downgrades*, p. 13).

## ADDITIONAL RULES

The following additional rules apply:

- **Wounds:** If a player needs to check off a Fatigue box and the track is filled, automatically take a Wound (see p. 16).



- **Non-Feat Actions:** Certain non-Feat Actions, such as sprint, may automatically apply a Fatigue point (see p. 11).
- **Recovery:** Players may spend **Resolute Points** to recover (see p. 20).

## SPENDING RESOLVE (AFTER A FEAT ROLL)

On your character sheet, underneath the Resolve Attribute, is a 12 icon, with a certain number of circles. This represents your character's ability to spend Resolve.

After any Feat Roll, but before any success or failure against a Difficulty Rating has been resolved, you may choose to spend Resolve. To do so, you roll a 12 and add that to the total sum of the Feat Roll. (This is the only instance when a player effectively rolls four dice for a Feat Roll.)

**Times Per Session:** Spending Resolve can only be done once per roll. However, you can spend Resolve in different rounds a number times a game session equal to the number of circles on your character sheet. Each time Resolve is spent, mark off one of those circles.

**Wounds:** If the Resolve Attribute is Wounded, the player may still spend Resolve, but they roll a 10 (see *Wounds*, p. 16).

## SAMPLE FEATS

Below are sample Feats that you may use in a game. They also act as guidelines to help determine the dice pool of other Feats you come up with that are not covered below.

- **Animal Handling:** 8 + Animal Handling + Influence
- **Apply First Aid:** 8 + Medicine + Ingenuity
- **Apply Trauma Care:** 8 + 1 + Medicine + Ingenuity [Requires Trauma Kit]
- **Attack:**
  - **Close Attack:** 8 + Close Combat + Agility
  - **Ranged Attack:** 8 + Ranged Combat + Agility
- **Breaking Down Door:** 8 + Athletics + Endurance
- **Called Shot:** 8 + 1 + 1 + Ranged Combat + Agility [If any Wound(s) is applied, apply 1 extra Wound]
- **Con:** D8 + Acting + Influence
- **Evading Guards:** 8 + Stealth + Conviction

- **Intimidation:** 8 + Intensity + Influence
- **Jumping:** 8 + Athletics + Endurance
- **Notice Something:**
  - **Identify Object:** 8 + Awareness + Conviction
  - **Sneaking:** 8 + Awareness + Ingenuity
  - **Unusual (Outdoors):** 8 + Awareness + Survival
  - **Unusual (Social):** 8 + Awareness + Influence
- **Pick Lock:** 8 + Engineering + Ingenuity
- **Question Individual(s):** 8 + Persuasion + Influence
- **Repair**
  - **Electrical Device:** 8 + Electronics + Ingenuity
  - **Mechanical Device:** 8 + Mechanic + Ingenuity
- **Research:** 8 + Scholarship + Ingenuity [Must be information related to the character's Background.]
- **Search:**
  - **An Area:** 8 + Engagement + Resolve
  - **For A Person:** 8 + Engagement + Conviction
- **Sneaking:** 8 + Stealth + Resolve
- **Sway:** 8 + Persuasion + Influence

### AWARENESS VS. ENGAGEMENT SKILLS

While most of the Feats above are very self-explanatory, the interaction of Awareness and Engagement Skills is worth a closer look.

**Put simply, Awareness is passive while Engagement is active.** For example, looking on the Sample Feats list, you have Identify Object and Notice Someone Sneaking. Both of those are passive, inherent capacities where people use their innate abilities to notice differences and contextualize new objects, which means they would use Awareness. Meanwhile, the Search an Area Feat requires dedicated, active thought, and so it falls under Engagement.

Use that active/passive litmus test in any event where situational awareness is important and you're unsure if you should be using Awareness or Engagement.



## EXAMPLE

You are attempting to fire a Makeshift Bow at a rare, lone street light to sneak through the city easier.

First, despite your arguments that it's a run-of-the-mill shot, the GM decides it's a Called Shot due to the size of the target, and so they impose a  $\downarrow$  +  $\downarrow$ . What's more, you're trying to be as silent as possible, lying in the snow, and so another  $\downarrow$  is applied.

Next, the GM starts with the standard Difficulty Rating of 13, but the target is at long range, and it's dark, so they shift the Difficulty Rating up to 19.

You start building the Feat Pool by grabbing  $\otimes$  8 and mentally noting the  $\downarrow\downarrow\downarrow$  (or marking it with tokens or chits or whatever is most useful).

Next, you and the GM note that Ranged Combat Skill is attached to the Feat of a Ranged Attack. Your character doesn't have a great skill in that yet, with only a  $\otimes$  6, so you add that to the pool.

Luckily for you, the indicated Attribute for the Feat, Agility, is superb for your character, sitting at a  $\otimes$  10 (they usually do hand-to-hand work instead of firing weapons).

Finally, you check under the Modifications column of the Makeshift Bow. Normally, that would not apply a Modification, but the GM previously told you it was a high-quality make and gave you a  $\uparrow$ .

This leaves the Feat Pool at:  $\otimes$  8 (Feat Die) +  $\otimes$  6 (Ranged Combat Skill) +  $\otimes$  10 (Agility Attribute) +  $\downarrow$  (Called Shot) +  $\downarrow$  (Called Shot) +  $\downarrow$  (laying down) +  $\uparrow$  (high-quality weapon)

You could decide to cancel an  $\uparrow$  and a  $\downarrow$  out and apply  $\downarrow\downarrow$ , or apply them all. You choose the latter and change the final Feat Pool to:  $\otimes$  4 +  $\otimes$  4 +  $\otimes$  12.

You roll and come up with a 17. Not bad at all for your dice... but a failure. Next time, have the better bowman take the shot; you'll have to just sneak through with that light active, knowing the GM will likely throw on an  $\uparrow$  for it if anyone comes hunting...

## USING UPGRADES/DOWNGRADES

$\uparrow$  and  $\downarrow$  from a character sheet are always applied.

However,  $\uparrow$  and  $\downarrow$  beyond the character sheet can also be awarded by the GM. They should be the primary (if not sole) rewards for different tactical decisions made in the course of gameplay. If players do something that gives them an obvious advantage, that should be reflected by giving them an  $\uparrow$  or even  $\uparrow\uparrow$ . Conversely, if players take an action that would obviously hinder them (whether by trying something difficult, such as

a multiple weapons attack, or by making an error in judgment as to what their best approach should be),  $\downarrow$  are the best response.

The following guidelines should be used when distributing  $\uparrow$  and  $\downarrow$ .

- In an Opposed Feat, the effects of  $\uparrow$  on one player or  $\downarrow$  on another are virtually the same. This means that when all options are equal, choose the effect that changes the player's roll, rather than anything that the gamemaster is rolling.
- One  $\uparrow$  should be a relatively common phenomenon, whether it is due to equipment, circumstances, or other effects.  $\uparrow\uparrow$  should be significantly more rare.  $\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow$  is the most that can be given, and that should only be distributed in the most extraordinary circumstances. The same is true for  $\downarrow$ . A character may never have more than three net  $\uparrow$  or  $\downarrow$  (that is, the final result after all possible  $\uparrow$  and  $\downarrow$  have been compiled and have canceled each other out) on a single roll.
- The player may cancel  $\downarrow$  with any  $\uparrow$  or choose to apply them all. In all instances, the player chooses which die is  $\uparrow$  or  $\downarrow$ , as needed. While the differences between choosing one die or another are small, players should be allowed to have that degree of control.

GMs, here are some circumstances with defined  $\uparrow/\downarrow$ :

## COVERT OPS

- **Sneaking:** Gear and tactics to promote sneaking should provide an  $\uparrow$ . They can stack to  $\uparrow\uparrow$ , but not  $\uparrow\uparrow\uparrow$  unless there are extraordinary circumstances.
- **Spotting:** Vision and other enhancements give  $\uparrow$ .

## SOCIAL

- **Good argument:** When a player makes an argument that is logically sound or appeals to the interests of the other party through roleplaying (i.e., not by making a Feat Roll), they receive an  $\uparrow$ . When they do both, they receive  $\uparrow\uparrow$ .
- **Intimidating appearance:** Characters with an Endurance of  $\otimes$  10 or  $\otimes$  12 automatically receive an  $\uparrow$  on Intimidation Feat rolls. Intimidating tactics generally receive an  $\uparrow$ , though gamemasters may use discretion in determining the effectiveness of particular tactics.



## COMBAT

- **Cover, partial:** Player in cover receives an ↑ on Defense Rolls.
- **Cover, total:** Player in cover receives ↑↑ on Defense Rolls, but ↓ on their attacks made while in cover.
- **Multiple weapons attack:** When using multiple weapons in a single attack, take ↓↓ on each attack.

## COMBAT

The following covers combat within *Dice Core*.

## MOVEMENT 6

All character movement is in meters, as is indicated on your character sheet.

## INITIATIVE

If at any point the players and GM determine that the order of various actions taken by players and NPCs matters (usually combat but could be covert sneaking into a camp), they roll for Initiative Order using the following rule:

## ROLLING INITIATIVE 7

When rolling Initiative, players select their Agility, Ingenuity, and Resolve Attribute Dice and roll, summing the numbers and informing the GM of the results. (For ease of selection during the game, each character sheet includes an Initiative box where these dice are already located.) The GM then rolls for each NPC, as needed.

## INITIATIVE ORDER

The GM builds the Initiative Order, highest to lowest value results, for all players and each NPC. The GM will then start at the highest value, allowing that player their Feat, then shift down to the next highest value for their Feat, and so on, for the first round. If there are ties, anyone who rolled second (or third, and so on), takes their actions second (and third, and so on).

## NON-FEAT ACTIONS

In *Dice Core*, actions fit into one of two categories: Feat and **non-Feat**. The Sample Feats listed earlier in this section provide the basic idea for what Feat actions are. Those actions and all similar actions fit into the same time frame, meaning you can only take one such action per turn (during any portion of the game that requires Initiative Order; see above).

There are certain non-Feat actions that can be taken in a turn along with a Feat; **on any turn, you can take one Feat action and up to two non-Feat actions**. In the vast majority of circumstances, non-Feat actions will not involve a dice roll, though gamemasters have discretion to include a roll if they think something about a player's situation imposes significant difficulty (such as attempting to make a hand gesture while being affected by a paralytic agent). Non-Feat actions are listed below (if an action is not listed below, assume it takes the time needed for a Feat, and thus should be considered a Feat action, even if there is no roll involved):

- **Certain Awareness Rolls:** While Engagement rolls require a Feat action, certain Awareness rolls can be made (per GM discretion) as a non-Feat action. This action would be for things such as looking quickly around a room, noticing the sources of a loud noise, and so on. This should not be used to give detailed information to players.
- **Drop item:** If something is in your hands and you don't want it there, you can drop it!
- **Drop prone:** You may drop to the ground as a non-Feat action. The gamemaster determines what effect that has on attacks and Defense based on particular circumstances.
- **Gesture:** Simple hand motions—pointing, a finger over the lips to request silence, that sort of thing—can be made as a non-Feat action.
- **Run:** This means moving up to or equal to the distance indicated by your Run movement speed.
- **Sprint:** This means moving up to or equal to the distance indicated by your Sprint movement speed and greater than your Run movement speed. This is a non-Feat action, but you receive a ↓ on any attacks made while sprinting. Attacks made against you while you are sprinting also receive a ↓. If a character Sprints more than two turns consecutively, apply a Fatigue point (see p. 11).
- **Talk:** You can say a few quick sentences. Basic guideline: If you can say it in three seconds, you can say it as a non-Feat action.



- **Turn Simple Device On/Off:** If the power switch to a simple device is within movement range, you can turn it on or off as a non-Feat action. The basic standard for this action is a light switch—if the power switch is the same level of complexity as a light switch, this action can be used. If it's significantly more complicated, it will take a full Feat action.

## RANGED & CLOSE ATTACK ROLLS

When combat is about to occur, you will review the situation you are in in the game, which will help you determine whether you use a Ranged Attack or Close Attack Feat Roll. What you choose might not only depend upon your position relative to a target but will also depend upon your skills and the weapons you have at hand.

Once you've determined which Feat you'll attempt, you build the Feat Pool exactly as shown under *Making A Feat Roll* (see p. 9), and toss your dice!

**Sprint:** A player cannot make a Combat Feat Roll in the turn they Sprint.

## DEFENSE ROLL 8

The target of the Combat roll makes a Defense Roll, rolling their Armor + Agility + Resolve Dice. (For ease of selection during the game, your character sheet includes a Defense box where these dice are already located.) The result of that Defense Roll generates the Difficulty Rating against which the attacker rolls.

The damage generated if the attacker roll is equal to or higher than the Difficulty Rating generated by the Defense Roll is covered under Damage (see below)

## DEFENSE RATING (OPTIONAL)

Rather than make a separate Defense Roll, some groups may prefer to use a static target number to compare to attack rolls. All NPCs (and creatures) include a Defense Rating (in parenthesis next to Defense), which is the average Defense roll of that NPC, that can be used as a threshold

Your group should determine before you start a session how this will work at your table. For example, you might just have NPCs using the Defense Rating, or perhaps all NPCs

and PCs will use the Defense Rating, or perhaps even some players will do it one way and some another. Determining beforehand what your group will use can significantly cut down on potential confusion during the game.

## SURPRISE

You may attempt to surprise other characters, using the following guidelines.

- **Attacker:** Each attacker can make a Stealth Feat Roll against a DR of 16. On a success, the DR for defenders noticing the attack goes up by 3. It increases an additional 3 for each Critical Success during that Stealth roll.





- **Defender:** Generally speaking, a target needs to make a successful Awareness roll against a DR of 13 to notice a planned surprise attack (assuming they have a way to perceive the intended battleground, such as line of sight or a monitoring device at the scene).
- **Additional Effects:** Characters who are surprised take an immediate -3 to their Initiative roll and a  on their first Defense roll.

## WEAPONS

Weapons include a number of stats shown below on the Sample Weapons table. They are also on the character sheets for those characters carrying weapons; these can be used by GMs to create additional weapons, as the need arises.

- **Item:** Name of the weapon.
- **Range:** In meters. Up to the first value is a standard Feat. From the first value up to the second value, the player receives a  for using this weapon.
- **Wounds:** The number of Wounds applied when a weapon is used to successfully attack a target.
- **Critical Success:** An Attack Feat imposes a Critical Success if it exceeds the Defense Roll (or Defense Rating) by the indicated amount. For each Critical Success above the target, an additional Wound is inflicted.
- **Modifications:** Any  or  that are applied to an Attack Roll made using this weapon.
- **Notes:** Additional rules, if any.

## DAMAGE

As noted above, when making an Opposed Feat Roll for a Combat Feat, both players (or the player and the GM) roll. The defender makes a Defense Roll by selecting their Armor, Agility, and Resolve dice (again, noted under Defense on their character sheet) and rolls, summing the numbers, while the attacker makes their Ranged/Close Attack Feat Roll. The higher number wins, with ties going to the attacker.

**Defense Rating:** If using Defense Rating, then only one person will be rolling for the attack (see p. 14).

## WOUNDS

### (SUCCESSFUL FEAT ROLL)

If the attacker's roll equals or succeeds the Difficulty Rating generated by the defender (or the Defense Rating), a number of Wounds are automatically applied, as indicated by the weapon.

## CRITICAL SUCCESS

An Attack Feat imposes a Critical Success if it exceeds the Defense Roll (or Defense Rating) by the weapon's indicated amount. For each Critical Success above the target, an additional Wound is inflicted. For example, if the defender made a Defense Roll with a result of 9 as their initial Difficulty Rating to be hit and the attacker rolled a 15 on their Attack Roll and the Critical Success value of the weapon is 3, that would be two Critical Successes. That means in addition to

### SAMPLE WEAPONS

| FIREARMS • ITEM  | RANGE  | WOUNDS | CRITICAL SUCCESS | MODIFICATIONS                                                                           | NOTES                                                                                                                               |
|------------------|--------|--------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Makeshift Pistol | 15/30  | 1      | 5                | +  |                                                                                                                                     |
| Pistol           | 20/40  | 1      | 4                | +  |                                                                                                                                     |
| Composite Bow    | 60/120 | 1      | 4                |                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                     |
| Hunting Rifle    | 80/160 | 2      | 3                | +  | Apply cumulative  for every 10 meters below 30 |
| MELEE • ITEM     | RANGE  | WOUNDS | CRITICAL SUCCESS | MODIFICATIONS                                                                           | NOTES                                                                                                                               |
| Knife            | 0      | 1      | 5                |                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                     |
| Spear            | 2      | 2      | 4                |                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                     |
| Sledgehammer     | 1      | 2      | 3                | +  |                                                                                                                                     |
| Sabre            | 1      | 1      | 3                |                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                     |



**COMBAT EXAMPLE**

Despite all your best talking, combat explodes in the frostland. You're trying to use your composite bow to hit a raider that's running to reinforce a position to return fire on your team. It's your turn in the Initiative Order.

The GM tells you the NPC managed to reach long range for your bow (more than 60 meters) before you could fire, so you need to apply a . Also, the target moved behind a low snowbank and so is in cover, so you'll need to apply a second .

Since you know you already have , you decide to take a chance and try to convince the GM that you are taking careful aim; they agree and give you an , but the penalty they apply is that you cannot move the next turn.

You then come up with an even wilder idea. In your conversations with the raiders—before things went sideways—you heard them whistling loudly at each other, as though communicating. You make your argument to the GM that for your one Non-Feat Action, you will whistle very loudly in an attempt to mimic the raiders and see if you can't shock the NPC into a poor decision.

The GM laughs at the audacity, agrees, and tells you to make a Con Feat [16] Roll. You don't have Acting but will give it your best shot and build the Feat Pool: (Feat Die) + (No Skill) + (Influence Attribute). You roll and get a 22! Not only did you just max out your roll, but you achieved two Critical Successes. The GM describes the NPC stumbling and coming to a standstill, looking in confusion in your direction. As a result, you get another ; the GM, because of the amazing two Critical Successes, decides to give you a third .

You already know this is a Ranged Attack Feat, so you start to build the Feat Pool: (Feat Die) + + (Ranged Combat Skill) + (Agility Attribute). You then have and . (You quickly review the Modifications column of the composite bow on your character sheet and find there are no Modifications.) While you can apply them in any fashion you wish, you decide to cancel the with , leaving you an . You decide to the highest die, leaving you with a + + .

The GM grabs the Defense dice of the NPC: + (Armor) + (Agility) + (Resolve). After the of to a , the GM rolls simultaneously with you. The NPC generates a low Difficulty Rating of 11, but your roll is only a 10! Since this is an important moment, you Spend Resolve—marking that on your sheet—to roll a . You get an 8, which transforms your 10 to an 18!

You then review your composite bow stats on your character sheet. You note that by equaling or exceeding the target's DR, you will inflict 1 Wound. However, you also note the weapon's Critical Success is 4. By rolling 7 over the DR, you get one Critical Success, so instead of just 1 Wound, the NPC will apply 2 Wounds. (If you'd rolled just one more on that Spend Resolve die, you would've had 19, or two Critical Successes, so the target would've received 3 Wounds.)

Regardless, two Wounds is a great result, and they are applied to the NPC, which will severely limit them. It's now the next player's turn.

the original Wound (provided the weapon used only applies a single Wound), the strike does two additional Wounds, for a total of three Wounds.

## ARMOR CRITICAL

During a successful Opposed Combat Feat, if the attacker generates three Critical Successes with their roll (as determined by the weapon they are using; i.e., if it has a Critical Success of 2 then rolling 6 more than the target's Defense roll), the target player's armor receives a Critical; they check that box on their character sheet (see p. 18). This is treated exactly like a Wound, meaning any future Defense Rolls now include a .

**Critical Already Checked:** If the Armor Critical box is already checked when an Armor Critical occurs, instead the hit automatically generates 1 additional Wound.

## WOUND TRACK

Your character sheet has a Wound Track.

Assign Wounds to the first open cell, from top to bottom, on your character's Wound Track.

- **X Skill Wounds:** You mark the Wound box on any Skill, up to the number indicated; i.e., a 2 Skills cell would mean marking Wounds for two Skills that you choose.
- **X Attribute Wounds:** You mark the Wound box on any Attribute, up to the number indicated; i.e., a 2 Attributes cell would mean marking Wounds for two Attributes that you choose.
- : You can take no more actions until healed.
- : Your character is killed.

If you cannot apply a Wound because all Skills or Attributes are already Wounded, no further effects are applied.

Here's an example Wound Track from a character that's advanced through many game sessions:

### WOUND TRACK

SKILL

ANOTHER 2 SKILLS

ATTRIBUTE

ANOTHER 2 ATTRIBUTES

ALL FEATS

**Wound Boxes:** On your character sheet, each Skill and Attribute has Wound boxes you check upon receiving such a Wound. This is an easy way to determine when are applied for future Feat Rolls. Multiple cannot be applied to the same Skill or Attribute (i.e., the same die).

For example, if you've taken an Attribute Wound and choose to apply that Wound to Agility, you would mark the box underneath the Agility icon, as well as the Wound boxes for Agility in the Initiative and Defense sections. For future Initiative, Defense, and Skill Feat rolls with a Linked Agility Attribute, after building the Feat Pool, you then automatically apply the from that Agility Wound.

**Cumulative:** All are cumulative. For example, a player with a Close Combat Skill Wound, an Agility Wound and an All Feats Wound would apply after building the Dice Pool for a Close Attack Feat. (As usual, though, remember that no more than a net three Modifications can be applied to a Feat.)

**Specifics (Optional):** To the right of each Wound descriptor, in each cell of the Wound Track, is space where you may, if you so choose, write in the type of Wound your character received, based upon where it's applied. For example, if your character takes a "Skill Wound," and they apply it to Ranged Combat, the Wound could be a "broken hand" for your character's trigger finger (you would write that in). Meanwhile, if they continue with more Wounds and have to apply an "Attribute Wound," and you decide to apply it to Ingenuity, that could be a nasty "concussion" (again, you would write that in). Each of those provide a wonderful way for you to create the roleplaying you want to experience going forward.

## HEALING

When healing, you start at the bottom of the wound list and move to the top.

## HEALING FEATS

Make a First Aid Feat or Trauma Care Feat (must use Trauma Kit), both of which you can find on the Sample Feats table (see p. 12), against the following Difficulty Rating:

| WOUNDS           | DIFFICULTY     |
|------------------|----------------|
| Skill Wound      | Standard (13)  |
| Attribute Wound  | Hard (16)      |
| All Feats Wound  | Very Hard (19) |
| Knocked Out (KO) | Very Hard (19) |

## RESULTS

- **First Aid Success:** Heal 1 Wound
- **Trauma Care Success:** Heal 2 Wounds
- **Critical Successes:** For each Critical Success in First Aid or Trauma Care, heal 1 additional Wound.

When a cell is healed of damage, remember to erase the Wounds on the corresponding Skills and Attributes. If the character is healed of the Knocked Out Wound, they immediately wake up.

For example, using the Wound Track above, let's say that a player has received six Wounds, so when another player attempts a First Aid Feat, their Difficulty Rating is 19. They roll a 25, giving them two Critical Success, so the character heals a total of three Wounds. The next First Aid Feat to heal Wounds on that character would roll against a Skill Wound, so the Difficulty Rating would only be 13.

**No Medicine Skill:** If a character does not have the Medicine Skill, they may still try to make a First Aid Feat, using the usual 4. If a character attempts a Trauma Care Feat, as they have the Trauma Kit, but do not have the Medicine Skill, in addition to the 4, apply one (which means , as the Feat itself applies one).

## TIMING

A character can only make one Healing Feat for another specific character once per day. That means, how-

ever, that if multiple people want to try a Healing Feat for a character in a day, they can.

Wounds can be treated daily through attempts at Healing Feats (even if it is just one), with success treated as described above. Failure does not change the character's condition unless the Feat Roll has three or more Critical Failures (i.e., the Feat rolls nine or less below the DR); in this case, one additional Wound is immediately applied.

**Skill Wounds:** Unlike Attribute Wounds, which can only be healed through a Healing Feat, Skill Wounds can heal on their own. For every two days the character is not involved in any strenuous activities, they automatically heal one Skill Wound on the Wound Track (provided all Wounds below it on the track are healed). If they are involved in strenuous activities, this increases to every four days.

**Spending Resolve:** A player may spend Resolve to add a die to a Healing Feat.

## RUNNING IN THE SNOW

The following additional rules and details enable you to bring *Frostpunk* to your table in a way that will make it memorable.

Besides Hope, Discontent, and Population (which are noted in the mission), you, as the gamemaster, may decide which of these to use or not use in your first game. But we highly recommend them all for the most immersive *Frostpunk* experience.

### FAITH & ORDER

Life in the frostland can be merciless and settlement leaders have a regular question to ask: In a world of uncertainty, how do I inspire people to continue? For *Frostpunk* purposes, approaches are grouped into two categories: Faith and Order.

The primary purpose of Faith is to unite people in belief of a cause greater than themselves, to encourage them to work toward something they cannot always perceive or understand. The organizing ideas of Order is that proper procedures breed good habits, and proper habits build good character.

While full rules for Faith and Order are beyond the scope of this QSR. NPCs in the mission have ratings for both that the gamemaster can use or ignore as they see fit.

## HOPE & DISCONTENT

No matter what, the city must survive. While the lack of resources can destroy your city—in which case your characters likely die as well—nothing impacts the city more powerfully than Hope and Discontent.

- **Hope:** Hope represents citizens' belief that things will get better and that they are not working in the bitter cold for nothing. The more Hope a city and its people have, the more likely they are to work together in hard times and trust what they hear from their leaders. The less Hope there is, the less likely they are to help the leaders or anyone attached to them, and they will be less willing to do hard things for the sake of the city.
- **Discontent:** Discontent represents the day-to-day happiness and satisfaction of the people in the city. Low Discontent means the people enjoy their lives and are relatively happy. They are better able to endure a short-term crisis and are unlikely to steal from each other or get into fights. High Discontent, by contrast, can lead to large-scale riots and looting if left unchecked.

## TRACKING BOTH

Hope and Discontent run on a scale from 1 to 15. Ideally, a city will have high Hope and low Discontent. To start this *Frostpunk* game, set both Hope and Discontent to 8. The gamemaster should track both numbers in a way that is easily visible for the players. (The quick-start rules Gamemaster Screen has an area for tracking on the front.)

As Hope increases, people should pitch in more to help their city, work together, and focus on common problems. The PCs would benefit from this, as the increased cooperation would mean that citizens are more willing to help them out. More cooperation could mean  on Feats to persuade people to help, while lower Hope could result in . High Hope could result in the PCs gaining extra Resolute Points.

As Discontent increases, disagreements with leaders, thoughts of relocation, and public brawling all increase. The PCs will find the city increasingly difficult to navigate as high Discontent turns it into a violence-prone place.



## POPULATION

The central job of cities is keeping people alive. Every morning, designated teams make an exact count of those still living and momentarily mourn those who died. They bring bodies to burial pits or cemeteries, then set about trying to keep anyone else from dying in the next twenty-four hours.

Characters should feel every death, whether it's someone from their team or anyone in the city. Here are some suggestions for how to make this impactful (whether the deaths happen during the day or are found at sunrise):

- Every time someone in the city dies, sound a bell.
- If the players are away from the city, when they return, update the number so the players will work to find out what changed—and what went wrong. Reaching out to the captain would be a good idea to get the news.
- Naming every single NPC brings extra life to your games. Have a handy list of random names to read off to add weight to the event. The captain could even assign the players to read the names of the dead to the town.

## LOSING POPULATION

For these rules, the city population starts at 642. At the start of every day, change the population based on what happened the previous day.

The gamemaster should track this number in an easily seen way. (The quick-start rules Gamemaster Screen has an area on the front for easy tracking.)

## RESOLUTE POINTS

When it's your shift and you must crawl out from under the blankets into the bitter cold, despite your exhaustion. When you have to face down a raging polar bear as your team flees, hoping to bring home the knowledge of a precious new coal deposit. When the generator breaks down and you refuse to let your fellow citizens die, so you leap to fix it. When you must force a once-precious friend out into the cold because their sedition might destroy the city.

In all these circumstances, you must be resolute.

Resolute Points are awarded for good decision-making and actions that make the session more enjoyable for all.

**Tracking:** Players should track Resolute Points as they are earned and spent, preferably using physical items, such as coins or tokens. The group can never hold more Resolute Points than double the number of players.

## AWARDING RESOLUTE POINTS

The player group starts the adventure in these rules with 2 Resolute Points. Resolute Points are communal, but they are always earned individually.

When players accomplish one of the following actions, reward them with a Resolute Point:

- Significantly advances the plot
- Solves a problem that's blocked the group
- Delivers an appropriately humorous moment
- Engages in teamwork-oriented action
- Performs especially imaginative actions

The goal is simple: Reward the players for making the game more fun for everyone so that they are encouraged to do it more.

## SPENDING RESOLUTE POINTS

Resolute Points can be spent by individual players on specific actions, as noted below. (The number in parentheses indicates the number of points that must be used for that specific action.) When points are spent, remove them from the pool. Remember, though, if you're going to ask for the right to spend the group's points, be prepared to make your case for why it's important and how it will advance the group's success!

If a group is struggling with how to make this work, use the following guidelines: When a player wishes to spend Resolute points, they explain what they wish to do and pause to allow for any disagreement or alternate ideas. At least half of the players (rounded up) must disagree to stop the action from happening. If more than half say no, the player can try to persuade them. They have one minute to explain their goal, after which a new round of voting occurs. If half of the players (rounded up) still don't want to allow it, the points cannot be spent on that action.

- **Interfere (1):** Declare the use of this feat when an opponent's Feat roll is about to happen and you want to interfere with it. You must be close enough for the gamemaster to judge that there is a plausible way to interfere with the test. To interfere, you roll the same Feat-Skill-Attribute combo the character is attempting, but with your Skill and Attribute ratings. If you get a Standard success (13), the character with whom you are



interfering immediately takes a ↓. Each Critical Success you roll means an additional ↓. If you Interfere, you lose your next action (the Interfere attempt counts as your action), and your Initiative decreases by 2 for the rest of this Initiative Order.

- **Natural Healing (1):** Reduce the difficulty level of a Healing Feat made this turn by 3.
- **Counterstrike (2):** Immediately attack an enemy who just attacked you without using a Feat Action.
- **Extra Resolve (2):** Activate Resolve, even if you've already spent all your Resolve for this session (see *Spending Resolve*, p. 12).
- **Recovery (2):** Performing this action means you re-center and recharge yourself, attempting to eliminate your accumulated Fatigue (see p. 11). You cannot take any other actions (Feat or Non-Feat), nor Spend Resolve, during the turn you work on Recovery. If you take any Damage on the turn you are Recovering, the Recovery doesn't work. Once the turn in which you took this action is over, remove any and all accumulated Fatigue points.

**Players are encouraged to come up with new and unique ways to spend Resolute points, and convince the GM of why they should let it happen!**

## ENVIRONMENT

Gamemasters should always be ready to impose ↑ and ↓ based on how well characters are prepared for and respond to the weather. In opposed Feats, characters who are better prepared for the weather should gain ↑.

The weather also affects visibility. On sunny days, the glaze across the snow and ice can be intense, so characters should get ↓ on Awareness and Engagement Feats involving vision, unless they have some kind of eyeshade. Obviously, blowing snow and fog would impose ↓ on tests involving vision.

Cold and snow also make it harder to hear and smell things, so ↓ for Feats associated with smell and hearing can also be imposed as conditions deteriorate.

Lowered blood flow in cold temperatures make healing more difficult, so any Healing or First Aid Feats performed in extreme cold should receive a ↓.

**Glow Worm:** Each character's sheet includes a Glow Worm, which can mitigate the effects of the environment.

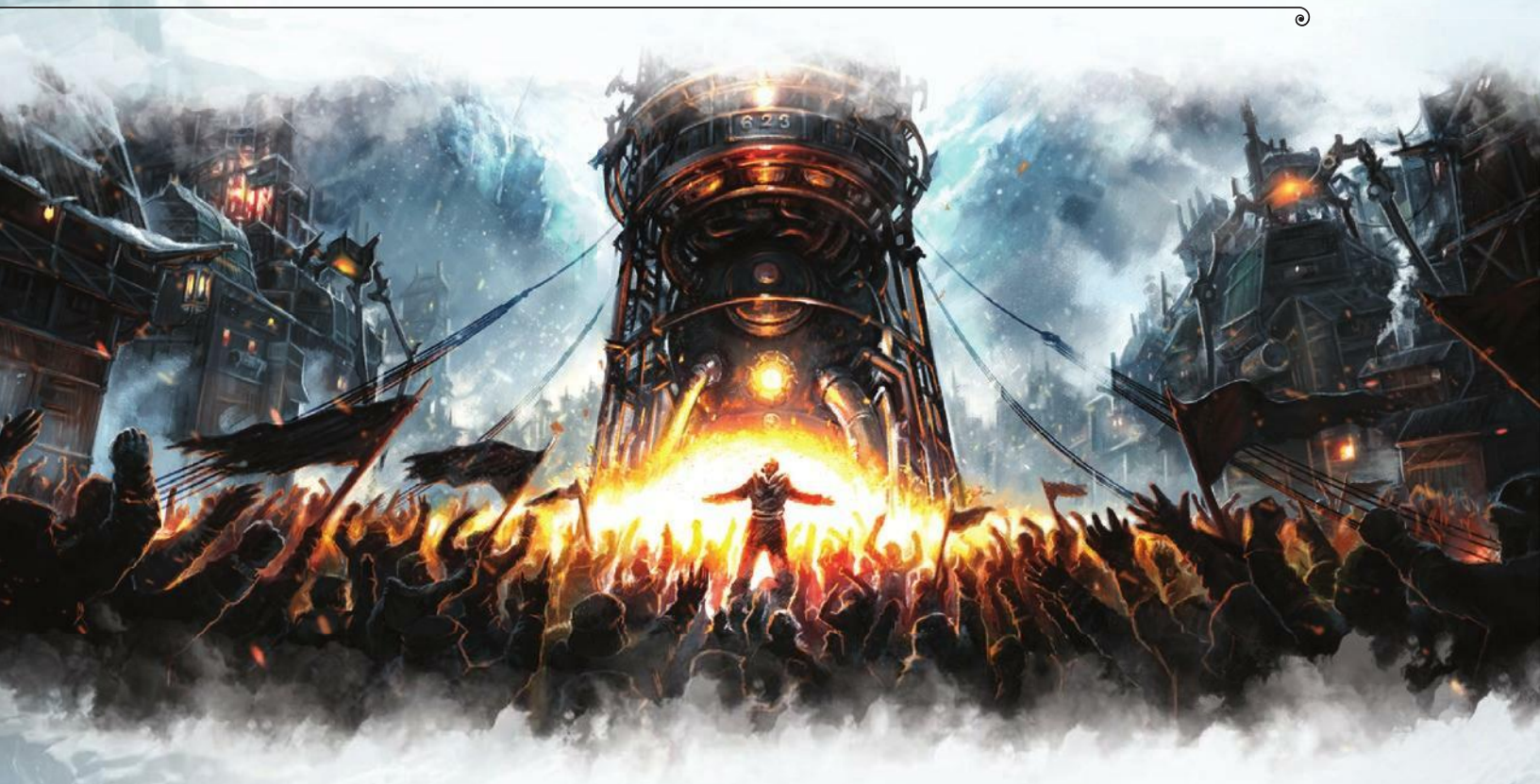




## MISSION

# FOR THE PEACE OF THE CITY

# GMs ONLY!



In this adventure, the players will be thrown in the middle of the various tensions, factions and hardships of life in the “last city on earth.”

The following are the pre-generated player characters in this mission (they are bolded in the text):

- **Clara Kevin:** Passive Tinkerer
- **Justin “Holy” Camburn:** Bard Priest
- **Martha Sweeny:** Passionate Doctor
- **Arnold Pierce:** Dedicated Servant

If an NPC is bolded, you can find their description and game stats in the *Characters of the Frostland* (some will only have the game stats).

If a Feat is suggested and it is not found in the Sample Feats, it will be displayed as: (D8 + **Gymnastics** + **Agility** [13] Feat).

This mission is divided into three parts, breaking up the major sections of the plot. This helps with pacing. If

the players move from this path, that’s okay; the game will still be fun.

## THE GOAL

This mission’s goal is to highlight the many aspects of the world of *Frostpunk*, from dissatisfaction with the government to the constant fear of freezing, as well as working with the different factions spreading their influence in order to make the city match *their* vision.

## For example:

- People are angry with the child labor laws
- The Bishop and the Marshal will try to convince the players to support their cause
- Fear of low supplies will make people afraid of working faster and disregarding safety

When running this mission, it’s important to give time and energy to these elements so players can understand the disparate aspects of New London.



## BOOK OF LAWS

As the city is founded and an influx of refugees spurs growth, the need to govern and ease pressures of people living in a community and trying to survive expands exponentially. Many laws are prudent, easing discontent while drawing out hope. Others are more strident, alleviating issues while introducing oft-times unintentional ramifications. And some laws come as the city and its people move perhaps too strongly on the path of Faith or Order, spawning pernicious and even horrifying consequences.

As with Faith and Order, full rules for these laws are beyond the scope of this QSR. However, the mission directly deals with those laws, and how players' choices connected to them will determine the outcome.

# INTRODUCTION

For the last ten years, the city of New London has stood as the capital of the Dominion of New London. While there have been struggles during this time, things have been more or less calm since the Great Storm, the subsequent conflict with the Edge settlement, and the concurrent plague that raged through the city.

The legendary Captain of the city has gone into complete isolation for reasons only his closest confidants have clues about. In his stead, Lieutenant Westover has been given the reins for the day-to-day running of the city. During this time, one of his new policies was the creation of the Dominion Expedition Forces (DEF). These would differ from the pure exploration and resource acquisition-focused standard expedition groups. They would be prepared to handle whatever tasks Westover or other leaders of the settlements within the frostland may need.

The player group is the second such created team, the first team having been loaned to Edge in good faith. Westover has personally selected three of the members of this crew, Burnham selected Arnold Pierce.

Recent accidents and short supplies in the last year has caused tensions to rise within New London, and Westover desperately needs the help of his new expedition force to deal with a recent crisis that may lead to violence in the streets if not resolved properly.

## PART ONE

# TROUBLE IN PARADISE

The session begins with **Lieutenant Westover** speaking to a crowd, celebrating the opening of the prosthetics factory that will allow many people to get new arms or legs and return to work. It's around 9:30 a.m.

Westover is standing on a small movable podium. The players are all standing to the right of the podium. Behind him is both **Bishop Alistair** and **Marshal Burnham**, the leaders of Faith and Order within the city. They both seem calm, but the players can tell there is tension between the two of them.

The players are here on Westover's request; he said he wished to talk to them after he finished with the factory opening.

Westover will thank **Clara Kevin** personally for their help in creating the factory. After Westover gives his remarks, there is applause, and a child walks up to Westover. The child is given a prosthetic by Westover. There is some cheering, and the assembly starts breaking apart, though most of the crowd mingle in conversation with each other.

As the crowd disperses, the Marshal walks up to the group. He will comment how content he is that there will be fewer useless people in the city. Burnham will ask **Arnold** personally if they are pleased to be in the new expedition group, saying that he got Arnold the position knowing he would serve the city well. The Bishop will start approaching, so the Marshal will annoyingly bid the players well and walk away before she arrives.

Bishop Alistair will chuckle at the Marshal running away, then ask how **Justin** is handling no longer giving sermons every week. She will also comment on her distaste for Burnham.

The players at this point can be given time to talk to people in the audience about how things are going in the city if they so wish. The following information can be discovered if the players engage some discussions:

- Most are excited that more people will be getting back to work
- A person is concerned about the coal mine collapse last month that injured a kid and slowed production
- Some are wondering if automaton repair can be managed next

After walking off the podium, Westover shakes hands and approaches the players. He thanks them for



coming and standing at attention for the first time as new expedition members. He then asks you to follow him back to his office.

• • •

Westover leads the players to his office on the second floor of the town hall. From there, the players are invited to sit while he takes his seat behind his desk, after making sure the door is firmly closed and no one is listening in. The room has little in the way of personal items but does have papers and books everywhere—the largest collection of books in the city, in fact.

After some small talk, Westover tells the players that he has something that needs to be taken care of today. The players are given the following information about the current issue:

- Westover has received a piece of paper on his desk letting him know that at 3:30 p.m., there will be an explosion in the coal mine unless the prosthetics factory is shut down.
- Only the people in this room as well as the Marshal and Bishop are aware of the threat.
- Tensions have been high in the city, with coal supplies low, and Westover fears that telling people will cause more issues than it will fix.
- He doesn't want to close the mine unless he has no other choice.
- He believes both the Marshal and Bishop have information the players can look into.
  - The Marshal knows about a theft in his armory.
  - The Bishop has information about an unusual confusion.
- They can also check the mine for clues, but they need to be discreet.
  - He recommends talking to the foreman about any questions they may have (**Tyler MaCath**)

Westover finishes by thanking the players for their service and apologizing for this being their first assignment.

## PART TWO

# HUNTING FOR RABBITS

The following is not set in chronological order, as the players will largely dictate where and when they look and how they want to proceed. As such, this section will give all the different places the players may go to find clues. If the players go to a spot not listed, you can move clues to locations where the players do go.

## THE MARSHAL

The Marshal is located near the generator. The building is a full metal structure, a rare sight. Two guards stand outside it with batons in their hands, though the players may notice they are not paying close attention, with one nearly falling asleep.

The guards will let the player characters enter the facility without saying anything. Once inside, the players will see Burham repairing a gun in the center of the room. The room itself only has a desk and two jail cells. There is another door, locked, on the far side of the room. Burham will welcome the group in without looking up from his gun.

Standing next to the armory door is a man in his thirties. He looks uncomfortable when the players come in. Players should role a (**Notice Something Unusual, Social [13] Feat**). If they succeed, they will notice the man seems uncomfortable with Justin in particular. The man's name is Leo Maston

If asked about the bomb threat, he says he's not sure he can trust the player group to handle the situation well, even if he does trust Arnold. He then tries to haggle with the players to get what he wants in return for the evidence.

- The Marshal knows someone stole equipment from the armory but won't let the players look at the crime scene without helping him.

He wants the players to convince Westover he needs guard towers to watch over troubled areas of the city.

He will also accept the players giving him breaking-and-entering rights.

- The players can also sneak in and find the info, but they might be discovered.



Trying to persuade the Marshal that the city needs protection requires a **(Sway [29] Feat)**; the difficulty drops to 16 if Arnold is then one rolling.

The door is a **(Pick Lock [13] Feat)** if the players wish to attempt to sneak in.

If the players are caught trying to break in, the Marshal will attempt to arrest them. If they are taken, Westover will then arrive an hour later and free the players. The Marshal will release them before then if they agree to convince Westover to give him everything he wants.

The players can ask for a list of people with demolition skills in the city. The list will include:

- Leo Maston
- Jackson Hamish
- Clara Kevin
- Brandon Norn (passed away)
- Westover

Talking with Leo will reveal he has a son, age six.

If the players get Leo alone, they will learn he attends church often, something the Marshal actively hates. He will comment that he wants something to bring everyone together so he doesn't have to hide his faith from the Marshal.

However, the players may find out he was in the bar all night drinking from the stress of his work situation. This would not have allowed him to leave the note in the church.

## ARMORY

In the armory, the players are pointed by the Marshal to the missing equipment, or they will need a **(Search an Area [13] Feat)** to find the missing supplies. The supplies in question are two empty boxes containing materials that can make a bomb.

Players may make a **(Engineering + Intelligence [13] Feat)**; success tells them that only someone with strong knowledge of explosives could make this bomb.

Giving the Marshall guard towers will spark unrest from the Faith faction. In addition, if the players get Westover to do this before going to the Bishop, she will not help them at all.

Giving the Marshall breaking-and-entering rights will cause less unrest but may still spell trouble in the future. Getting anything from the Bishop after this will increase the DR of any Sway Feats by 2.





## THE BISHOP

Giving the Bishop mandatory worship will create some unrest, especially from followers of Order. In addition, if the players get Westover to institute this before they talk to the Marshall, the Marshall will not help them at all.

Making the Bishop second in command will cause less unrest but may still cause trouble in the future. Any Sway Feat performed with the Marshall after this has its Difficulty Rating increased by 2.

The church where Bishop Alsitar preaches is located in the residential area of the city, surrounded by houses and with a steam hub right in front of the building. A single pane of broken stained glass is located above the large doors.

A young woman is cleaning the pews. She doesn't give the players much attention when they enter.

The Bishop is at the pulpit, preparing for her sermon during the Night Prayer this evening. She requests the players wait while she finishes and then asks what she can do for them.

Alistair will tell the players that the young woman (Harper Smith) used to love blowing things up before she brought her into the church. At this comment, Harper will look annoyed and leave to another room.

*He hath shewed cold strength with  
his arm,*

*he hath scattered the proud of old empires  
in the imagination of their hearts.*

*He hath put down the mighty from  
their seat with the frost of his breath,  
and hath exalted the humble and meek  
beside the fires.*

*He hath filled the hungry with good  
things that still grow,  
and the rich he hath sent empty away  
into the ice.*

PORTION OF BISHOP'S SERMON

She will mention that the document she received was a written confession placed on her pulpit during the night. She will not say more, because God would not be happy if she violated the sacred nature of the confession. However, if she can give God something he wants in return, she may be able to make an exception.

- The Bishop will give the paper to the players if they support one of the following:
  - Mandatory worship every Sabbath
  - Westover's endorsement of the Bishop as second in command for the city

Trying to persuade the Bishop that the city needs protection requires a **(Charm [19] Feat)**; the DR drops to 16 if Justin is the one rolling.

While in the church, the players may find a button on the ground next to the podium **(Notice Something Unusual, outdoor [13] Feat)**. If asked, the Bishop will say she didn't notice it before.

*I don't do this so I'm not sure what  
to say but I can't do what I'm  
gonna do without confusing God.  
Please God, understand why people  
will do and expect me from these  
actions I have been forced too. What  
I do, I do for my child, and I don't  
ask nobody but God for forgiveness.*

CONFESSION LEFT ON ALTAR

## THE COAL MINE

The coal mine is at the wall of the crater. The steam cores and picks can be heard humming and clanging as the players approach the soot-covered building. The players will need to squeeze past people just to get inside the building. Bodies and gears are moving everywhere around the shaft.

A child can be seen working in the back.

A small woman will approach the players and ask what they are doing in her workplace.

Any lying to Tyler MaCath (The Foreman) will need a **(Charm [13] Feat)**.

If the players fail the Feat, she won't kick them out, but she also won't answer any questions they have.

If they succeed, she will share the following:

- Everyone here hates the work.
- The recent cave-in has made things harder.
- She's glad to get some good workers back thanks to the new prosthetics.

If asked why children work here, she says they are trying to not need them but some things require small hands. They hope they will be able to phase all the children out within a year.

During this chat, Jackson Hamish is called over and asked if they hate the work or not. They will respond that of course they do and they feel bad for the poor suckers who have to come back to work with the prosthetics. Hamish will add that they are glad their kid doesn't work here anymore.

Hamish will not have their coat at this time because of the heat from the mine. However, if the players see Hamish outside of the mine or ask to see his coat, they will find that it's missing a button.

If asked where he was last night, he'll say he was sleeping in his house with his kid.

If the players talk to other people in the mine, they may learn that Hamish has mentioned hating the new prosthetics law and has sworn to do something about it (**Sway (16) Feat**).

## TELLING TYLER THE TRUTH

If you tell Tyler the truth about the bomb threat, she will immediately close down the mine before answering any questions. She will thank you for telling her and will willingly help with whatever you need.

This will lead to the public knowing this information, which will cause discontent to rise in the city.

### PART 3

## PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER

Clues from the investigation the players may gather include:

- Only someone with demolition experience could make the bomb.
- The person has a child.
- The person wants the prosthetics factory shut down.
- A loose button was found in the church, where a confession was offered.
- Coal miners sharing remarks from Hamish.
- Hamish's lack of an alibi.

All of these clues should lead the players to Jackson Hamish. If they are struggling getting to this answer, you can have them roll (**Ingenuity + Ingenuity [16] Feat**) to start putting the clues together

## JACKSON HAMISH

Jackson Hamish is the person willing to blow up the coal mine if the prosthetics factory is not shut down.

### REASON

When the coal mine collapsed a month ago, Hamish's kid lost an arm. Jackson was furious about this and demanded that the child labor laws must be revoked. He got some support from others, but Westover ultimately denied his request. Westover stated that with the city's supply shortage, they still needed child





labor. He promised that once the supply shortage was resolved, he would revoke the law. Jackson was not entirely pleased with the half-measure, but with his son already out of work, he accepted this answer.

This would all change with the prosthetics factory, which would get his son an arm and thus get him back to work. Having failed to get Westover to change the law last time, Hamish felt he had no choice but to threaten violence to make sure his child wasn't sent back to work.

His time in the mine has given him the skills he needs to make a bomb as well as a spot to place it.

## CONFRONTING HAMISH

Hamish will be found in the coal mine for the entire day if the mine stays open. If the mine closes, Hamish will be in their house until they place the bomb at 3:20 p.m.

If Hamish is confronted he will attempt to convince the players he must go through with the bombing unless Westover changes his mind.

## DECISIONS AND OUTCOMES

Once the players have figured out who placed the bomb and why, they have the following options:

- Arrest Hamish
- Arrest Hamish and change the law
- Don't arrest Hamish and change the law

## ARRESTING HAMISH

If the players attempt to arrest Hamish, he will try to run and set off his bomb, killing himself if needed. The players may attempt to subdue Hamish, but he will fight the entire time. If Hamish is able to set off the bomb, the players may get hurt, and the coal mine will be shut down for weeks.

### OUTCOME

If the players arrest Hamish and the mine isn't destroyed, Westover will thank all the players greatly for their help. He will say he regrets that the laws are the way they are and will change them as soon as he can.

If the mine was destroyed, there will be coal shortages, and many people will die from the cold before it is fixed.

The city will manage its supply problem, and the law will be repealed in two months. However, two weeks before the law is repealed, Hamish's child will get their leg crushed by a gear, losing another limb.

## ARRESTING HAMISH AND CHANGING THE LAW

If the players attempt to arrest Hamish, he will try to run and set off his bomb, killing himself if needed. The players may attempt to subdue Hamish, but he will fight the entire time. If Hamish is able to set off the bomb, the players may get hurt, and the coal mine will be shut down for weeks.

If the players promise they will change the law if Hamish turns himself in, they can attempt a **(Charm [16] Feat)**. If they succeed, Hamish surrenders.

Westover will thank the players for finding Hamish and will agree to change the law if that will prevent future issues.

### OUTCOME

Hope will rise from the removal of the child labor law. However, some people will get frostbite and lose limbs from the coal running low before the mine returns to full production.

## NOT ARRESTING HAMISH AND CHANGING THE LAW

This option will work similar to arresting him, but Westover will be annoyed by the players and will need to be swayed (influenced by how the game played out) in order to change the law. If the law is not changed, Hamish will once again try to blow up the mine.

## OTHER OPTIONS

There are many different ways things may end outside of these primary options. However, most of them will be similar to how these ends take place. You do not need to fill out every detail for what happens, but you should paint a good picture of how the players' actions affected the city. This can include looking at how the relative power of Faith and Order may have shifted, along with the rise and fall of Hope and Discontent, and what that means for the city going forward



## FROSTPUNK

# CHARACTERS OF NEW LONDON

## KNACKS

A combination of natural abilities, work, and life experiences give us Knacks, things we can accomplish above and beyond what others may do in similar circumstances.

Complete rules for how player characters have and use Knacks are found in the *Frostpunk* core rulebook. For these rules, the pre-generated characters do not have Knacks. However, to showcase their experience and expertise, several NPCs have Knacks.

## ARCHBISHOP DANIELLE ALISTAIR

Archbishop Alistair is a large, muscular woman who cares about her followers but also about her position in the religion and new territories. She always wanted to be a priest, but the laws at the time did not permit it. She does not wish harm to come to anyone but will not let that get in the way of furthering her cause. She is always at odds with Marshal Burnum over how the city should be run.

*"How can I help you, my child?"*

**Height:** 6'2"

**Hair Color:** Black

**Eye Color:** Green

**Age:** 47

**Gender:** Female

**Sexual Orientation:** Gay

**Faith & Order:** 7/1

|            |            |             |            |            |             |
|------------|------------|-------------|------------|------------|-------------|
| <b>End</b> | <b>Agi</b> | <b>Conv</b> | <b>Ing</b> | <b>Inf</b> | <b>Rslv</b> |
| 8          | 6          | 8           | 6          | 10         | 10          |

## SKILLS

- **Awareness:** 6 + ↑
- **Engagement:** 8
- **Persuasion:** 10 + ↑
- **Scholarship (Theology):** 6 + ↑

## BACKGROUND

Priest (Theology)

## DEFENSE (RATING)

6 + 6 + 10 (13)

## TRAITS

- **Disposition:** Judicious
- **Integrity:** Kindness to the weak
- **Personality:** Mystical and inspiring

## INITIATIVE

6 + 6 + 10

## BONDS

- The Church of New London
- Bishop Tobin

## KNACKS

- **The Call of the Spirit:** Once per session, + ↑ for any Conviction or Resolve Feat.
- **Language of Faith:** You know how to talk to other members of the path of Faith. When engaging in a social test with another follower of Faith, + ↑.
- **Order Rival:** You inherently mistrust anything someone from Order tells you.

## WEAPONS & EQUIPMENT

City Winter Clothing



## MARSHAL RICHARD BURNUM

Burnum is a short, stout man intent on bringing his style of Order to the frostland and the United Territories of New London. He saved Westover from an assination attempt when Westover was trying to become Lieutenant, and they have been together ever since. He always has his hand on his pistol, the only firearm permitted for use within the city.

Burnum wants to increase his control over the city but loves and respects Westover and will never do anything to endanger him.

*"This city must survive, the others are optional."*

**Height:** 5'5"

**Hair Color:** Brown

**Eye Color:** Hazel

**Age:** 38

**Gender:** Male

**Sexual Orientation:** Straight

**Faith & Order:** 2/7

|            |            |             |            |            |             |
|------------|------------|-------------|------------|------------|-------------|
| <b>End</b> | <b>Agi</b> | <b>Conv</b> | <b>Ing</b> | <b>Inf</b> | <b>Rslv</b> |
| 10         | 8          | 8           | 6          | 6          | 6           |

### SKILLS

- **Athletics:** 8
- **Awareness:** 6
- **Close Combat:** 10 + ↑
- **Persuasion:** 6 + ↑
- **Survival:** 6 + ↑

### DEFENSE (RATING)

4 + ↑ + 8 + 6 (13)

### BACKGROUND

Marine (Armed Forces)

### INITIATIVE

8 + 6 + 6

### TRAITS

- **Disposition:** Imprudent
- **Integrity:** Loyalty
- **Personality:** Commander

### BONDS

- Captain Westover
- Order

### KNACKS

- **Aura of Power:** Gain an ↑ when attempting an Intimidation Feat against anyone with an Awareness of 6 or lower.
- **The Call of Duty:** Once per session, + ↑ for any Conviction or Influence Feat.
- **Knock Heads:** Sometimes people need to just shut up and listen. When people disagree with you, roll 8 + Conviction + Resolve [13] or lose your temper and attempt to yell and pummel people into submission.

### WEAPONS & EQUIPMENT

- Expedition Clothing

| Item   | Range | Wounds | Critical Success | Mods |
|--------|-------|--------|------------------|------|
| Pistol | 20/40 | 1      | 4                | + ↓  |

## LEFTENANT MARTIN WESTOVER

Westover is a rather scrawny man who lost an arm in a machine accident due to terrible work conditions during the plague. He led the movement to replace the current lieutenant after the captain went into reclusion, and after surviving an assination attempt was able to create a large enough movement to make it happen. The old lieutenant was exiled, and Westover took over. He is still weak from the plague, and many people worry that he will not survive long.

He is a very kind but determined man. He wants the Dominion to work together, but New London still comes first if push comes to shove.

*"\*cough\* I deeply hope it doesn't come to that."*

**Height:** 5'8"

**Hair Color:** Dirty Blond

**Eye Color:** Green

**Age:** 36

**Gender:** Male

**Sexual Orientation:** Straight

**Faith & Order:** 3/4

End 6 Agi 4 Conv 12 Ing 8 Inf 10 Rslv 8

### SKILLS

- **Awareness:** 6
- **Persuasion:** 12 + ↑
- **Leadership:** 8
- **Survival:** 6 + ↑

### BACKGROUND

- Coal laborer (Mines and Quarries)

### DEFENSE (RATING)

8 + 4 + 8 (12)

### INITIATIVE

4 + 8 + 8

### TRAITS

- **Disposition:** Open-minded
- **Integrity:** Fairness
- **Personality:** Mediator

### BONDS

- New London
- Bethany Westover (sister)

### KNACKS

- **Beloved:** All NPCs around this character may move in the way of any attack as a Non-Feat Action if they are within a meter.
- **The Call of the Cavern:** Once per session, + ↑ for any Endurance or Conviction Feat.
- **Weak:** Takes double damage from all attacks.

### WEAPONS & EQUIPMENT

- Leather-Enhanced EC

## BEACON MASTER

The Beacon Master is a cranky old man with amazing eyesight who hates when people ask things of him but also always wants to be doing something helpful. He has worked as Beacon Master for as long as New London has existed. No one knows his real name, and he ignores anyone who asks about it.

*"Ye aw are really weird, you know that, don't ya?"*

**Height:** 5'3"

**Hair Color:** Bald

**Eye Color:** Hazel

**Age:** Unknown

**Gender:** Male

**Sexual Orientation:** Unknown

**Faith & Order:** Unknown

End 6 Agi 6 Conv 8 Ing 10 Inf 4 Rslv 6

### SKILLS

- **Athletics:** 8
- **Awareness:** 12
- **Close Combat:** 4 + ↑
- **Persuasion:** 6 + ↑
- **Survival:** 6 + ↑

### BACKGROUND

Unknown\*

### DEFENSE (RATING)

6 + 6 + 6 (11)

### INITIATIVE

6 + 10 + 6

### TRAITS

- **Disposition:** Indifferent
- **Integrity:** Unknown\*
- **Personality:** Unknown\*

### BONDS

- The Beacon
- Unknown\*

\*To be determined by the GM as needed; can actually change from scene to scene, if desired.

### KNACKS:

- **Eagle eye:** Auto succeeds if they need to make a Notice Something Feat involving other NPCs or player actions.

### WEAPONS & EQUIPMENT

- City Winter Clothing



## MAX NORBIT

Max lived with Jessica Norbit before she went to Edge and would eventually become its leader. He currently serves as an advisor and cleric to Captain Westover. Max is often seen as enthusiastic but naive, often pitching ideas that are overly idealistic and have no chance of working. His connection to her has left many people wondering if his loyalty is to her or New London. Captain Westover has never shared in these doubts and intrinsically trusts Max.

*"This will be fun, right?"*

**Height:** 5'7"

**Hair Color:** Red

**Eye Color:** Green

**Age:** 30

**Gender:** Male

**Sexual Orientation:** Straight

**Faith & Order:** 5/3

|            |            |             |            |            |             |
|------------|------------|-------------|------------|------------|-------------|
| <b>End</b> | <b>Agi</b> | <b>Conv</b> | <b>Ing</b> | <b>Inf</b> | <b>Rslv</b> |
| 6          | 6          | 8           | 8          | 8          | 6           |

### SKILLS

- **Athletics:** 6
- **Awareness:** 6

- **Close Combat:** 4 + ↑
- **Persuasion:** 6 + ↑
- **Survival:** 6 + ↑

### BACKGROUND

- Post office (Clerical)

### DEFENSE (RATING)

6 + 6 + 6 (11)

### INITIATIVE

6 + 10 + 6

### TRAITS

- **Disposition:** Helpful
- **Integrity:** Committed
- **Personality:** Energetic

### BONDS

- Jessica Norbit
- The people he serves

### KNACKS

- None

### WEAPONS & EQUIPMENT

- City Winter Clothing

## CREDITS

### CATALYST GAME LABS

**Dice Core Design:** Randall N. Bills & Jason M. Hardy

**Writing:** Bryn K. Bills, Randall N. Bills, Jason M. Hardy

**Development:** Bryn K. Bills, Randall N. Bills, Talon L. Coleman, Jason M. Hardy

**Editing:** Jason M. Hardy

**Graphic Design & Layout:** Matt Heerdt

**Art Direction:** Brent Evans

**Playtesters:** Thanks to all of the amazing playtesters!

### 11BIT STUDIOS

**Design and consultation**

Marcin Eller

Łukasz Juszczuk

Karolina Kruk

Dawid Kurowski

Jakub Stokalski

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Abdyon

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- Fco. Peña Blas -

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fco.p.blas@hotmail.com



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NAME

Clara Kevin

DICE CORE™

## ATTRIBUTES

ENDURANCE



WOUND



AGILITY



WOUND



CONVICTION



WOUND



INGENUITY



WOUND



INFLUENCE



WOUND



RESOLVE



WOUND



FEAT ROLL



RUN/SPRINT

10m/20m

## SKILLS

FEAT = D8 + SKILL + ATTRIBUTE + MODIFICATIONS (IF ANY).

NO SKILL = D4

AWARENESS

(Ingenuity)



WOUND



CLOSE COMBAT

(Agility)



WOUND



ENGINEERING

(Ingenuity)



WOUND



MECHANIC

(Ingenuity)



WOUND



SCAVENGING

(Conviction)



WOUND



SCHOLARSHIP

(Ingenuity)



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



## KNACKS

THE CALL OF THE SPIRIT:

+ Upgrade for any Conviction or Resolve Feat.



## DISPOSITION

All truths, whether spiritual or secular, are one.

## INTEGRITY

Honest. Too honest.

## PERSONALITY

Innovative inventor with an unquenchable thirst for knowledge.

## BACKGROUND

Metal Worker

## WOUND TRACK



skill:



another 2 skills:



ATTRIBUTE:



another 2 attributes:



ALL FEATS:

UPGRADES/  
DOWNGRADESFATIGUE  
TRACK

## QUIRKS



NAME

## Justin "Holy" Camburn

DICE CORE™

## ATTRIBUTES

ENDURANCE



WOUND



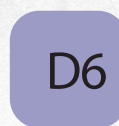
AGILITY



WOUND



CONVICTION



WOUND



INGENUITY



WOUND



INFLUENCE



WOUND



RESOLVE



WOUND



FEAT ROLL

RUN/SPRINT

15m/30m

## SKILLS

FEAT = D8 + SKILL + ATTRIBUTE + MODIFICATIONS (IF ANY).

NO SKILL = D4

D12

ACTING (Influence)



WOUND



AWARENESS (Ingenuity)



WOUND



Theology (Ingenuity)



WOUND



LEADERSHIP (Conviction)



WOUND



PERSUASION (Influence)



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



WOUND



## KNACKS

THE CALL OF CRAFT: Once per session, + Upgrade for any Agility or Influence Feat.



## DISPOSITION

The only consequences that matter are when you win.

## INTEGRITY

You'll aid anyone, with a smile. But only if it doesn't cost you too much.

## PERSONALITY

Enthusiastic, creative and sociable free spirit, who can always find a reason to smile.

## BACKGROUND

Theology

## WOUND TRACK



2 skills:



another 2 skills:



2 ATTRIBUTES:



another 2 attributes:



ALL FEATS:

UPGRADES/  
DOWNGRADES

D12

D10

D8

D6

D4

FATIGUE  
TRACK

## QUIRKS



NAME

## Arnold Pierce

DICE CORE™

## ATTRIBUTES

ENDURANCE

D10

WOUND

AGILITY

D6

WOUND

CONVICTION

D10

WOUND

INGENUITY

D4

WOUND

INFLUENCE

D6

WOUND

RESOLVE

D8

WOUND

FEAT ROLL

RUN/SPRINT

15m/30m

## SKILLS

FEAT = D8 + SKILL + ATTRIBUTE + MODIFICATIONS (IF ANY).

NO SKILL = D4

D12

ALTHETICS (Endurance)

USED

D4



WOUND

AWARENESS (Ingenuity)

USED

D8

WOUND

CLOSE COMBAT (Agility)

USED

D6



WOUND

RANGED COMBAT (Agility)

USED

D8

WOUND

STEALTH (Conviction)

USED

D6



WOUND

SURVIVAL (Endurance)

USED

D6

WOUND

WOUND

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

WOUND

## KNACKS

**INDEFATIGABLE:** Once per session, when a point of Fatigue would normally be applied, you may roll D8 + Endurance + Conviction; on a result of 15 or more, you do not have to add the point.

USED

USED

USED

USED

USED

USED

## DISPOSITION

All truths can be found in the snow.

## BACKGROUND

**STONE QUARRIER**  
(MINES AND QUARRIES)  
Coal labourer, stone quarrier, metals-miner, and so on.

## WOUND TRACK



skill:



another skill:



ATTRIBUTE:



another attribute:



ALL FEATS:



## INTEGRITY

Filled with loyalty. Often giving it to those that do not warrant it.

## PERSONALITY

Flexible and charming, always ready to explore and experience something new.

UPGRADES/  
DOWNGRADES

D12

D10

D8

D6

D4

FATIGUE  
TRACK

○

○

○

## QUIRKS



NAME

Martha Sweeny

DICE CORE™

## ATTRIBUTES

ENDURANCE



WOUND



AGILITY



WOUND



CONVICTION



WOUND



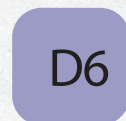
INGENUITY



WOUND



INFLUENCE



WOUND



RESOLVE



WOUND



FEAT ROLL

RUN/SPRINT  
10m/20m

## SKILLS

FEAT = D8 + SKILL + ATTRIBUTE + MODIFICATIONS (IF ANY).

NO SKILL = D4

AWARENESS (Ingenuity) WOUND

USED +

CLOSE COMBAT (Agility) WOUND

USED

MEDICINE (Ingenuity) WOUND

USED

PERSUASION (Influence) WOUND

USED

SCAVENGING (Conviction) WOUND

USED +

SCHOLARSHIP (Ingenuity) WOUND

USED +

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

WOUND

USED

## KNACKS

THE CALL OF CRAFTSMANSHIP: Once  
per session, + Upgrade for any Endurance or  
Ingenuity Feat.

USED

USED

USED

USED

USED

USED

## DISPOSITION

Inquisitive but not to extremes.

## BACKGROUND

Tailer

## WOUND TRACK

skill:

another 2 skills:

ATTRIBUTE:

another 2 attributes:

ALL FEATS:

## INTEGRITY

The city must survive, but not at  
the cost of its people.

## PERSONALITY

Very dedicated and warm, always  
ready to defend those you know.

UPGRADES/  
DOWNGRADESFATIGUE  
TRACK

## QUIRKS

SAMPLE FEATS

| FEAT               | ROLL                                                                                                  | FEAT                   | ROLL                                                                                      |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Animal Handling    | 8 + Animal Handling + Influence                                                                       | Sneaking               | 8 + Awareness + Ingenuity                                                                 |
| Apply First Aid    | D8 + Medicine + Ingenuity                                                                             | Unusual (Outdoors)     | 8 + Awareness + Survival                                                                  |
| Apply Trauma Care  | 8 + Downgrade + Medicine + Ingenuity [Requires Trauma Kit]                                            | Unusual (Social)       | 8 + Awareness + Influence                                                                 |
| Attack             |                                                                                                       | Pick Lock              | 8 + Engineering + Ingenuity                                                               |
| Close Attack       | 8 + Close Combat + Agility                                                                            | Question Individual(s) | 8 + Persuasion + Influence                                                                |
| Ranged Attack      | 8 + Ranged Combat + Agility                                                                           | Repair                 |                                                                                           |
| Breaking Down Door | 8 + Athletics + Endurance                                                                             | Electrical Device      | 8 + Electronics + Ingenuity                                                               |
| Called Shot        | 8 + Downgrade + Downgrade + Ranged Combat + Agility [If any Wound(s) is applied, apply 1 extra Wound] | Mechanical Device      | 8 + Mechanic + Ingenuity                                                                  |
| Con                | 8 + Acting + Influence                                                                                | Research               | 8 + Scholarship + Ingenuity [Must be information related to the character's Back-ground.] |
| Evading Guards     | 8 + Stealth + Conviction                                                                              | Search                 |                                                                                           |
| Intimidation       | 8 + Intensity + Influence                                                                             | An Area                | 8 + Engagement + Resolve                                                                  |
| Jumping            | 8 + Athletics + Endurance                                                                             | For A Person           | 8 + Engagement + Conviction                                                               |
| Notice Something   |                                                                                                       | Sneaking               | 8 + Stealth + Resolve                                                                     |
| Identify Object    | 8 + Awareness + Conviction                                                                            | Sway                   | 8 + Persuasion + Influence                                                                |

UPGRADES & DOWNGRADES

- COMBAT
  - Cover, partial: ↑ on Defense Rolls.
  - Cover, total: 2 ↑ on Defense Rolls, but 1 ↓ on their attacks made while in cover.
  - Multiple weapons attack: Take 2 ↓ on each attack.
- COVERT OPS
  - Sneaking: Gear and tactics to promote sneaking should provide an ↑. They can stack to 2 ↑, but not to 3.
  - Spotting: Vision and other enhancements provide 1 ↑.
- SOCIAL
  - Good argument: Make an argument that is logically sound or appeals to the interests of the other party through roleplaying, receive an ↑. If both, receive 2 ↑
  - Intimidating appearance: Characters with an Endurance of 10 or 12 automatically receive an ↑ on Intimidation Feat rolls. Intimidating tactics generally receive 1 ↑.

SAMPLE WEAPONS

| RANGED | RANGE | WOUNDS | CRITICAL SUCCESS | MODIFICATIONS | NOTES |
|--------|-------|--------|------------------|---------------|-------|
| Pistol | 20/40 | 1      | 4                | + ↓           |       |

| MELEE | RANGE | WOUNDS | CRITICAL SUCCESS | MODIFICATIONS | NOTES |
|-------|-------|--------|------------------|---------------|-------|
| Knife | 0     | 1      | 5                |               |       |
| Spear | 2     | 2      | 4                |               |       |

FEAT ROLLS & THE FEAT POOL

BUILDING THREE-DICE POOL

- First Die ( 8 Feat)
- Second Die (Skill)
- Third Die (Linked Attribute)

UPGRADES/DOWNGRADES

- Make Any Modifications (↑ or ↓)

MAKE THE FEAT ROLL

- Roll Feat Pool

- Success: Final amount is equal to or greater than the Difficulty Rating.
- Defeat: Final amount is less than the Difficulty Rating.
- Critical Successes: Every 3 over the Difficulty Rating is 1 Critical Success.
- Critical Failures: Every 3 under the Difficulty Rating is 1 Critical Failure.

SKILLS

ENDURANCE

Athletics  
Intensity  
Survival

AGILITY

Close Combat  
Gymnastics  
Ranged Combat  
Sleight of Hand

CONVICTION

Engagement  
Leadership  
Scavenging  
Stealth

INGENUITY

Awareness  
Engineering  
Forgery  
Investigation

Medicine  
Mechanic  
Scholarship (Job Classifications)

- Agriculture, Husbandry, Fishing
- Armed Forces
- Building
- Factory
- Mines and Quarries
- Professional, Clerical and Local Government
- Retail, Foodstuffs, and Hostelries
- Transport and Communications
- Workshops and Handicraft
- Theology

INFLUENCE

Acting  
Animal Handling  
Persuasion

COMBAT

INITIATIVE

Agility + Ingenuity + Resolve

DEFENSE

Armor + Agility + Resolve

DIFFICULTY RATING

| RATING    | TARGET     |
|-----------|------------|
| Very Easy | 7 or more  |
| Easy      | 10 or more |
| Standard  | 13 or more |
| Hard      | 16 or more |
| Very Hard | 19 or more |
| Master    | 22 or more |
| Legendary | 25 or more |

SKILL STAGES

| STAGES       |
|--------------|
| 4 (no skill) |
| 6            |
| 4 + ↑        |
| 8            |
| 6 + ↑        |
| 10           |
| 8 + ↑        |
| 12           |
| 10 + ↑       |
| 12 + ↑       |

HEALING FEATS

| WOUNDS           | DIFFICULTY     |
|------------------|----------------|
| Skill Wound      | Standard (13)  |
| Attribute Wound  | Hard (16)      |
| All Feats Wound  | Very Hard (19) |
| Knocked Out (KO) | Very Hard (19) |

RESULTS

- First Aid Success: Heal 1 Wound
- Trauma Care Success: Heal 2 Wounds
- Critical Successes: Critical Success in First Aid or Trauma Care, heal 1 additional Wound.

